

Social media bubbles

Social media is designed to identify a person's interests and tailor the content they see according to their "likes" and what they share. This can be really useful in filtering out things they aren't interested in, but also means that the news that appears on their social media platforms only offers a narrow point of view. When people simply absorb this news without seeking other perspectives, they don't get the full story. This creates a "bubble" effect that stops people from seeing viewpoints that differ from their own.



TEEN HINTS

Keep an open mind

Try to look for news and opinion from a variety of sources and many different opinions, including those that you don't like or agree with. Taking measures to be an active news consumer will help you to form your own informed thoughts and opinions on important matters.

Escaping overexposure

It can sometimes feel like there's no escape—especially when the news focuses on alarming events. It's natural to feel angry, sad, or anxious about it all. Taking time away from the media can help teens to digest the news and properly understand their reactions to it.

▽ Taking time out

Going for a walk, playing with a pet, and speaking to friends are all great ways to relax.



PARENT TIPS

Disturbing news

It can be exciting when teens take an active interest in current affairs, but it's also important to help them digest the news they consume. Ask their opinions on different viewpoints, including difficult topics. When there are particularly distressing news items, remind them that it's possible to be informed about what is happening without knowing every detail.

Social conscience

Many people seek out ways to help a particular cause they've seen on the news. Getting involved can introduce a teen to like-minded people, which can be energizing and inspiring, as can talking to and debating with people who have rival views.

